



A word from the chairperson -

Welcome to the Spring update from NECRET. Spring brings a new sense of purpose and direction. We as a board are busy getting ready for many upcoming events in the coming months including the Women's Mini Marathon, Boyne Camino Walk and the infamous Dip in the Nip. All of these events promote NECRET's aim to improve the outcome and experience of all patients attending our own Oncology unit. I hope that you and your family can join us at some of our events. We are extremely grateful to all our sponsors and volunteers who help make these events a success. I wish you renewed energy and hope during your journey with us and we welcome any feedback regarding how we a charity can help the Oncology unit deliver quality person focused health care.

Nursing Updates

As spring arrives—with lighter days, fresh blossoms, and a sense of renewal—our nursing team is feeling that same lift in energy and optimism. This season reminds us that even small signs of change can bring comfort, strength, and hope.

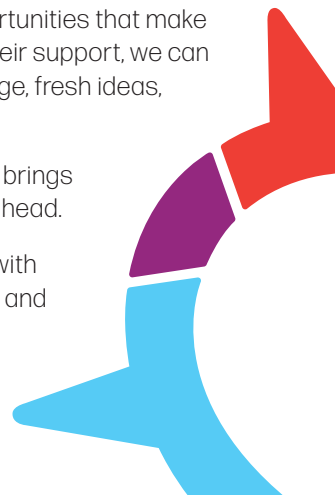
Just as the world around us begins to grow again, our team is growing in skill and knowledge too. We are always learning, always improving, so we can give the very best care to our patients and families. Whether it's learning new skills, attending specialist courses, or finding better ways to support you, we are committed to moving forward with kindness and confidence.

In 2025, with the help of NECRET we were able to send our nursing colleague Mairead to attend a "Foundations in Haematology module" in St. James Hospital. Sharon, our health care assistant was sponsored to complete the "Mindwell at work facilitator training." Counselling sessions, (both group and individual) have been funded for staff members to aid with self-wellbeing.

We want to say a heartfelt thank-you to our NECRET. Their generosity helps us access important training and learning opportunities that make a real difference in the care we provide. Because of their support, we can continue to develop as nurses—bringing new knowledge, fresh ideas, and renewed energy back to our day ward.

This spring, we feel inspired. And we hope this season brings you moments of comfort, warmth, and brighter days ahead.

Thank you for being part of our community. Together, with the support of NECRET, we will keep growing, learning, and caring—every step of the way.



County Louth Golf Club Raises €23,588 for NECRET

The members of County Louth Golf Club proudly presented a cheque for €23,588 to the North East Cancer Research & Education Trust (NECRET) following a year-long fundraising effort led by Lady Captain Karen Healy.

From the very beginning of the captaincy year, members embraced NECRET as the Lady Captain's chosen charity. What followed was a true club-wide effort, with ladies, men and junior members all playing their part. Fundraising took place through sponsored competitions, raffle draws, charity days and generous individual donations, with many members quietly giving above and beyond.

There was a strong sense of shared purpose throughout the year. For many within the club, NECRET's work at Our Lady of Lourdes Hospital is deeply personal. Members have seen first-hand the impact of the Oncology & Haematology Unit and were determined to give something meaningful back to the service that supports families across the North East at their most vulnerable time.



Pictured: Martha McCabe, Ricky Morgan, Martin Healy, Catherine O'Brien, Terry Fitzgerald, Jimmy Carroll and Karen Healy.

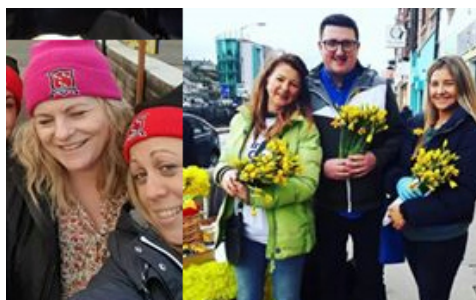
Businesses also provided valued sponsorship, while volunteers worked tirelessly behind the scenes selling tickets, sourcing prizes and ensuring every event ran smoothly. The final total of €23,588 stands as a testament not only to generosity, but to the strong community spirit that defines County Louth Golf Club.

Lady Captain Karen Healy expressed heartfelt thanks to every member, sponsor and volunteer who contributed in any way, noting that this achievement belongs to the entire club.

County Louth Golf Club is proud to support NECRET and the vital work it continues to do for cancer patients and their families throughout the North East.

In Praise of Our Volunteers

As a small organisation our volunteers play a crucial role in helping us pursue our mission. Their valuable time and expertise are greatly appreciated. Our flag day collections take place in Dundalk on Friday October 16th followed by our Drogheda Flag Day on Saturday October 17th. Volunteers can join the NECRET volunteer team by texting 086 7773294.



Upcoming Dates

- **April** is Bowel Cancer Awareness Month
- **May** is Cancer Awareness Month
- **May 8th** is World Ovarian Cancer Day
- **May 12th** is International Nurses Day
- **May 13th** is Vhi Women's Mini Marathon
- **July 18th** Boyne Valley Camino Challenge
- **August 16th** Bikes and Trikes
- **September** is Prostate Cancer Awareness Month
- **September 13th** Dip in the Nip

More details on NECRET events please visit <https://www.necret.ie/index>

How you can support NECRET

Further information on how to donate, organise a fundraising event or support in other ways can be found at www.necret.ie/donate and www.necret.ie/fundraise

Researchers Bench

A new breath collection device, designed to detect lung cancer cells in a patient's breath, has been developed by Dr. Sinead Toomey and Professor Bryan Hennessy, supported in large part by NECRET funding. This innovative device is now being used in Ireland's first lung cancer screening trial. The technology has the potential to enable earlier diagnosis of lung cancer and to help identify more effective treatment options for patients who receive a cancer diagnosis.



Impact of NECRET

NECRET continues to make a positive impact across our local community. We were delighted to join Drogheda Chamber of Commerce, creating new opportunities to work together in supporting better health and wellbeing. We were also honoured to receive the Kingsbridge Private Hospital Excellence in Healthcare Award, recognising the collective efforts of our supporters, volunteers and community in improving cancer care.



Chairperson: Elizabeth Summersby

CEO: Ciaran Briscoe

Secretary: Mary P Meade

Board Members: Anna Harbison Egan, Paul Egan, Mark Doran, Prof Bryan Hennessy, Andrea Moore Prof. Reem Salman, Niamh Thornton and Jackie Quinn.

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